Seven hot new sources of leadership inspiration

2026-10-29 · Seven hot new sources of leadership inspiration

From amoebae to impalement

We’re thrilled to share the highlights of our winter catalogue. Following the success of our recent titles on the leadership lessons of Genghis Khan and Alexander the Great, we are bringing you a series of books with management takeaways from absolutely anyone and anything we can think of. Galleys are available on request.

“Start With Die: Leadership Lessons from Vlad the Impaler” by Derek Fromage. “When a man or a prince is strong and powerful he can make peace as he wants to; but when he is weak a stronger one will come and do what he wants to him.” In this contrarian take on the effects of appalling brutality within organisations, Derek Fromage, author of the bestselling “Dare to Bleed”, looks at the career of Vlad III. You’ve read the case for psychological safety. Now learn how Vlad’s high-stakes leadership philosophy can work for you.

“Rhyme and Reason: The Kindergarten CEO” by William Winkie. If you think nursery rhymes are for toddlers, think again. The traditional songs of childhood are crammed with management insights. Great leaders are consistent: it’s frankly confusing to be marched to the top of the hill and then marched straight back down again. Great leaders set shared goals: what’s the point in Polly putting the kettle on if Sukey is just going to take it off again? Great leaders understand the strengths of their team members: who can eat no fat, say, and who can eat no lean. Features practical takeaways on the use of tuffets.

“Meteor: The Katie Zacharia Story.” Sometimes, it all comes down to one moment. No one has any idea who you are, but the eyes of the world are suddenly upon you. Can you seize your opportunity? Katie Zacharia did. In less than 15 minutes at the podium in the White House briefing room, she showed everyone just what she was capable of. To find out how to go from obscurity to household name, read Katie’s stunning new memoir. Because meteors don’t always rise.

“Wham Bam! Lyrics and Leadership” by Eddie Vintner-Twist. To understand their employees, leaders have to inhabit their worlds. And there is no less obvious way to do that than to listen to 1980s pop songs. From the stigma of joblessness (“Wham, bam! I am a man; Job or no job, you can’t tell me that I’m not”) to fears of the apocalypse (“Ninety-nine red balloons; Floating in the summer sky”), celebrated music journalist Eddie Vintner-Twist squeezes every last drop of meaning, and more besides, from the lyrics of his youth.

“Singular: What the Amoeba Can Teach Organisations in the Age of AI” by Renée Roper. Artificial intelligence makes it possible to run organisations that are leaner than any in

history. But how can businesses grow without adding complexity? The secret can be found in nature. The amoeba is a single-celled organism that can adapt to any environment. Rather than creating permanent layers of bureaucracy, it uses temporary extensions called pseudopods to change its shape and make progress towards its objectives. If you want to run a unicorn, you have to think like an amoeba. Features a foreword by Sam Altman (not that Sam Altman).

"The Trojan War MBA". Felicity Jetsam takes six famous episodes from the story of the Trojan War and reveals the workplace dilemmas behind them. If the CEO humiliated you in public by poaching one of your minions, should you follow the example of Achilles and go on strike? Agamemnon's decision to sacrifice his own daughter in order to propitiate an angry goddess may seem a little harsh, but what if you had to set aside your own interests in order to calm a furious board member? And if you saw a large wooden horse outside your office, are you sure you wouldn't bring it inside?

"Four the Win! Why Table Legs Are The Ultimate Team Players" by Madge Trestle. The top of a table may take the glory, but the legs make everything possible. Without legs, a table would be just a piece of wood on the floor. Table legs cannot operate independently from their peers. They must always act together; even slight deviations in length cause everything to wobble. Features case studies on some of the most celebrated table legs in history, including the one in the Stauffenberg plot and some others that currently escape us.

Step inside the world of work with our Bartleby newsletter . Each week our white-collar oracle muses on the agonies of office life.